

Sergei Emelianov

Senior Backend Developer / Lead Engineer (PHP, Go)

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Moscow, Russia · Russian citizen · Not relocating, open to business travel
Full-time · On-site, remote or hybrid

SUMMARY

Senior Backend Developer / Lead Engineer (PHP, Go) with 15+ years of backend development of high-load web services and enterprise platforms. Worked at leading Russian BigTech and fintech companies: Rambler&Co, Lamoda Tech, MTS Fintech, ETP Gazprombank, Avito.

I specialize in microservice architecture design (including DDD), integration of relational and NoSQL databases, event-driven architecture on Apache Kafka / RabbitMQ, and performance optimization. Strong in code review, mentoring and technical leadership (Team Lead at MTS Fintech, tech lead at Rambler&Co), task decomposition and estimation, and documenting architecture and APIs in Confluence. I use AI tools deliberately to speed up development and improve code quality.

Hands-on domain experience: ad-tech (bidding and auctions, ad-platform billing), fintech (centralized configuration microservice, RBAC), electronic procurement platforms under Russian federal laws 44-FZ and 223-FZ with integration into the government EIS (zakupki.gov.ru), classifieds billing (Avito), an international high-load social product with millions of profiles, and an OTA short-term rental service from the MVP stage.

WORK EXPERIENCE — 15 YEARS

Rambler&Co

March 2024 — present
Moscow · rambler.ru

Senior / Lead Backend Developer (PHP, Go)

High-load media portal (B2C, millions of users) — news and entertainment services; SOA and microservice architecture. Team of 10: development, QA, analytics, DevOps. Kanban.

Responsibilities

- Technical leadership: own architectural decisions, engineering standards and code quality; drive projects from requirements analysis to release.
- Mentoring and growing engineers: onboarding new team members, code review as a system, knowledge rotation.
- Task decomposition, estimation and prioritization; systems analysis of requirements.
- Bridge between business and engineering: turning business requirements into technical solutions; cross-team communication (product, analytics, infrastructure).
- Designing and building Go microservices; evolving the PHP 8 / Symfony 4 monolith; designing REST APIs and inter-service contracts.
- Integrating MySQL / PostgreSQL / MongoDB and Redis; event-driven communication via Apache Kafka; maintaining the Docker environment.

Key results

- Designed and shipped 10+ Go microservices to production (some from scratch), offloading the monolith.
- Contributed to breaking up the PHP / Symfony monolith — reduced code coupling and sped up feature delivery.
- Reworked the portal authorization system — a key user access-management subsystem.
- Established the code review process and technical documentation in Confluence — cut onboarding time for new engineers.

Stack: PHP 8, Symfony 4, Go, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, PHPUnit, Codeception, Docker, Confluence, GitLab.

Lamoda Tech

October 2022 — February 2024
Moscow

Senior PHP Developer

Internal services of Lamoda — one of the largest fashion e-commerce platforms in Russia and the CIS (millions of users). Scrum / Agile sprints. Grew from middle to senior during my tenure.

Responsibilities

- Developing internal services on PHP 8 / Symfony 4 / PostgreSQL.
- Migrating services to current PHP versions and updating Symfony dependencies.
- Writing unit and integration tests (PHPUnit, Codeception).
- Bug fixing, code review, maintaining coding standards.
- Technical analysis, decomposition and estimation of critical tasks.
- Configuring and optimizing the Docker environment and CI/CD pipelines.
- Adapting services to new regulatory requirements (integration with the Chestny Znak / CRPT mandatory product-labeling system).

Key results

- Migrated all team services from PHP 7.4 to PHP 8.1 — reduced technical debt, moved to an actively supported branch with security updates, removed deprecated and unsafe constructs.
- Upgraded key Symfony components to compatible versions — secured long-term framework support and ecosystem compatibility.
- Optimized CI/CD deployment pipelines — cut delivery time to production by about 30%.
- Covered the main service scenarios with unit and functional tests (PHPUnit, Codeception).
- Adapted services to the expanded list of product categories under mandatory labeling (Chestny Znak / CRPT) — the company met regulatory requirements on time, with no penalties.

Stack: PHP 8, Symfony 4, PostgreSQL, PHPUnit, Codeception, Docker, GitLab CI.

Rambler&Co

November 2021 — July 2022
Moscow · rambler.ru

Senior PHP Developer

Rambler&Co advertising platform (ad-tech, B2B): bid and auction management for ad placements, billing and reporting for advertisers of the portal's media network.

Responsibilities

- Developing and supporting ad-platform services on PHP 8 / Symfony 4.
- Improving the Go-based ad-placement bid management service.
- Designing and evolving internal REST APIs between platform services.
- Integrating asynchronous inter-service communication via Apache Kafka.
- Writing unit tests (PHPUnit).
- Conducting code review and controlling code quality.
- Maintaining the Docker environment for local development.

Key results

- Improved the Go-based ad-placement bid management service — a key subsystem driving media-network revenue.
- Extended and optimized banner bid management across adjacent platform projects.
- Improved the advertiser reporting subsystem — faster report generation and easier addition of new metrics.
- Evolved the platform's internal REST APIs: extended functionality and optimized endpoint performance.
- Refactored critical ad-platform modules — better readability and maintainability, lower regression risk.
- Covered key service scenarios with unit tests — more reliable releases.
- Prepared complete technical documentation and REST API specifications for internal consumers.

Stack: PHP 8, Symfony 4, Go, MariaDB, Redis, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, PHPUnit, Docker.

MTS Fintech

November 2020 — November 2021
Moscow · mtsbank.ru

Team Lead (PHP)

Fintech unit of MTS Bank — internal B2B services (centralized configuration, RBAC, admin panels). Team of 5–7 (engineers, QA).

Responsibilities

- Day-to-day management of a 5-engineer team: hiring, onboarding, motivation, one-on-ones, development plans.
- Technical interviews and hiring; mentoring Junior/Middle engineers (code review, growth guidance).
- Building and prioritizing the backlog with the Product Owner: handling business requests, sprint planning, task assignment (Scrum), facilitating ceremonies.
- Choosing the tech stack, making architectural decisions and enforcing code quality (PSR standards).
- Designing new services with DDD; designing data models and PostgreSQL migrations.
- Documenting architecture, APIs and business processes in Confluence.

Key results

- Initiated the team's move to Laravel + Orchid — faster delivery of admin panels and standard CRUD interfaces.
- Built a centralized configuration microservice from scratch with DDD (feature flags, pricing, business rules, admin panel) — a single source of truth instead of scattered settings.
- Single-handedly designed and implemented the RBAC subsystem (roles, permissions, API- and UI-level access control).
- Raised unit and functional test coverage of key scenarios to 85%.
- Introduced predictable Scrum planning and systematic code review, improving code consistency across the team.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Orchid, PostgreSQL, Redis, PHPUnit, JavaScript, Docker, Confluence, GitLab.

Webguru.pro

January 2017 — October 2020
webguru.pro

CTO / Co-founder

Full-cycle product studio (startup, co-founder): chatbots for Telegram / Viber / VK / Facebook, Yandex Alice skills, turnkey web services and CRMs. Clients ranged from local businesses to national companies (AB InBev, MegaFon, Alliance Retail Group, etc.). 50+ delivered projects. Team of 5–8 (engineers, QA). Own venture, run alongside my main job at ETP Gazprombank.

Responsibilities

- CTO and co-founder: technical and organizational leadership of the studio; product development strategy.
- Building and managing the engineering team (5–8 people): hiring, technical interviews, onboarding, mentoring and growth, workload planning.
- Client work: requirements gathering and analysis, specifications, concept approval, budget estimation and defense, negotiations.
- Service architecture design, tech-stack selection, API contract design.
- Backlog and priority management, task decomposition and assignment, deadline and quality control.
- Code review and hands-on implementation of key modules (middleware, billing, dialog builder).
- Acceptance testing, quality control, project handover and sign-off with clients.

Key results

- Launched the studio from scratch and grew it to 50+ delivered projects for major clients (AB InBev, MegaFon, Alliance Retail Group, etc.).
- Built the flagship SaaS Alice skill builder (AliceBot.pro) with a multi-platform core (Alice + Telegram + Viber + Facebook): 20+ data models, visual dialog builder, Robokassa billing.
- Built an HR bot automating first-stage candidate screening for retail chains — cut recruiting team time by 50–70%.
- Set up repeatable processes for development, code review and turnkey delivery; hired and grew the engineering team.

Stack: PHP 7, Phalcon Framework, Yii2, MySQL, Telegram / Viber / Facebook Bot API, Node.js, Angular, Robokassa, SendGrid, Docker.

ETP Gazprombank (electronic trading platform)

November 2016 — August 2020
Moscow · etp.gazprombank.ru

Senior PHP Developer

etpgpb.ru — Gazprombank's electronic trading platform (B2B): corporate procurement under 44-FZ and 223-FZ, integration with the government EIS (zakupki.gov.ru), auctions and participant billing.

Responsibilities

- Supporting and developing the etpgpb.ru web service in the corporate procurement segment.
- Designing and developing server-side PHP modules (Phalcon Framework, Zend Framework).
- Designing and implementing dedicated microservices for integrations with external systems and payment infrastructure.
- Improving frontend modules built on Ext JS.
- Refactoring and profiling the codebase, performance optimization.
- Conducting code review.

Key results

- Implemented integration with the government EIS (zakupki.gov.ru) through a dedicated Phalcon microservice — procurement data exchange compliant with 44-FZ and 223-FZ.
- Enhanced the etpgpb.ru trading system: shipped key platform features for corporate procurement, covered critical areas with tests, evolved Ext JS frontend modules.
- Built a dedicated billing microservice for auction participants on Phalcon: account top-ups and payment of participation fees.
- Integrated new payment instruments into the billing microservice — cards, acquiring, SBP (Faster Payments System).
- Migrated the project from PHP 5.6 to PHP 7 — noticeably faster backend thanks to the new engine.
- Performed deep refactoring of critical code with XHProf profiling, covering changed areas with PHPUnit tests beforehand to prevent regressions.
- Optimized complex PostgreSQL queries — lower response time for critical trading-system queries.
- Improved Sphinx full-text search over procurement notices and participant bids.

Stack: PHP 5.6 / 7, Phalcon, Zend Framework, Laravel, PostgreSQL, Redis, Memcached, Sphinx, JavaScript, Ext JS, RabbitMQ, PHPUnit, GitLab, YouTrack.

Avito

July 2016 — October 2016
Moscow · avito.ru

PHP Developer

Avito.ru — Russia's largest classifieds platform (B2C, tens of millions of users); payment subsystem and billing of paid services.

Responsibilities

- Supporting and developing modules of the Avito.ru payment subsystem.
- Designing and implementing server-side billing components in PHP.
- Integrating and maintaining payment-service APIs.
- Improving the billing microservice and adding new payment instruments.

Key results

- Integrated MIR card payments into the billing microservice — expanded payment options for private Avito users as the market moved to the national payment system.
- Improved payment-pipeline stability: reduced payment-processing errors (confirmed by monitoring).

Stack: PHP, PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, Redis.

Mamba

July 2015 — July 2016
Moscow · corp.mamba.ru

PHP Developer

tourbar.com (Mamba) — international high-load social service for dating and travel (B2C) with millions of profiles, monetized through a premium subscription.

Responsibilities

- Supporting and developing the tourbar.com web service (high-load, international product).
- Designing and implementing new feature modules.
- Integrating and maintaining payment APIs (PayPal, Paymentwall) for the premium subscription.
- Integrating and maintaining social network APIs (Twitter, VK, Facebook, Google, Instagram).
- Developing and evolving the REST API for mobile apps (iOS and Android).
- Optimizing PHP and SQL code for a large volume of profiles.

Key results

- Built the REST API from scratch for the Tourbar mobile apps (iOS + Android) — key endpoints for content and profile management.
- Implemented an in-house marketing mailing subsystem (digests, trip selections) with audience segmentation by geography, interests and activity — a mix of custom PHP code and an external email provider; improved open rates (confirmed by analytics).
- Improved full-text user search and filters on Elasticsearch — smooth work with a base of millions of profiles and flexible filter combinations.
- Implemented real-time display of online users.
- Integrated PayPal and Paymentwall for the premium subscription.
- Refactored existing code — better readability and modularity, easier further development.
- Extended the admin panel with tools for sending mailings and moderating user photos.

Stack: PHP, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, Memcached, RabbitMQ.

Sutochno.ru

October 2011 — July 2015
Ulyanovsk

Senior PHP Developer

sutochno.ru — OTA service for short-term rentals (B2C). Joined at an early product stage and grew from middle to senior over 3+ years, helping take the service from prototype to a stable product with thousands of hosts and hundreds of thousands of guests.

Responsibilities

- Designing and developing key server-side modules of sutochno.ru.
- Integrating external payment systems (Robokassa, PayU, Yandex.Kassa) and social OAuth login.
- Optimizing application architecture, PHP and SQL code for growing load.
- Developing the client side (billing, calendar, paid services) with responsive layouts.
- Contributing to related projects of the holding while keeping the shared architecture consistent.

Key results

- Helped take the project from an early prototype to a stable service with hundreds of thousands of guests.
- Designed and rolled out a unified payment system across Robokassa, PayU and Yandex.Kassa — one way to work with heterogeneous payment providers.
- Designed and built an auction system for promoting listings to the top (users bid and win positions) — increased paid-service conversion (confirmed by dashboards).
- Built the booking-calendar subsystem for rental properties — bookings grew after launch (tracked by product analytics).
- Designed an in-house analytics system for payment accounting and reports — according to the accounting team, it automated up to 90% of routine operations.
- Built paid services for promoting listings; implemented the client side of billing, calendar and paid services with responsive layouts (HTML5, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery).
- Implemented social login via OAuth 2.0 (Twitter, VK, Facebook, Google, Yandex).
- Performed deep refactoring with XHProf profiling, covering changed areas with PHPUnit tests beforehand to prevent regressions.
- Optimized complex MySQL queries for growing data volumes; used MongoDB for logs and analytics and Sphinx for full-text listing search.

Stack: PHP, MySQL, MongoDB, Sphinx, HTML5, CSS, JavaScript, AJAX, jQuery, JSON.

EDUCATION

2027 (in progress)	**HSE University (National Research University Higher School of Economics), Moscow** Faculty of Business Informatics — IT Product Management (Master's)
2012	**Ulyanovsk State Technical University, Ulyanovsk** Faculty of Information Systems and Technologies — Information Systems and Technologies in Computer Graphics Systems

CERTIFICATES & CONFERENCES

2026 Certificate of Oral Presentation — DMI 2026, 5th International Conference on Digitalization and Management Innovation (Xi'an, China)

2026 Certificate of Participation — ICAIMT 2026, International Conference on Artificial Intelligence Management and Trends (Abu Dhabi, UAE, online)

2026 Top-10 finalist, "Leaders of Digital Transformation" hackathon (Moscow Mayor's project) — "Negotiation Arena", a negotiation-skills simulator

2026 "Tochka Sborki" hackathon — finalist team (top 10), Digital Development Academy

2026 Robozon (Ozon Tech) hackathon, qualifying round — "Sorting-center simulation modeling" track

2026 Ostrovok hackathon — participant, "One step to the perfect hotel" track

2026 Intensive course "Building AI-Powered Products" (October 13–31, 2026)

2026 Agents Week intensive, Yandex School of Data Analysis

2026 Podlodka Techlead Crew #11 — Tech Lead in the AI Era

2026 Podlodka AI Crew — Season #4: Multi-Agent Systems

2026 Podlodka AI Crew #3 — AI-First Development

2026 Podlodka Go Crew #7 — Go Best Practices

2026 Podlodka Product Crew #8 — AI Tools for Product Managers

2015 Luxoft — "Software and IT Solution Development Project Management", IT Project Management module (custom course)

SKILLS

Languages & frameworks	PHP 8, Go, Symfony, Laravel, Phalcon, Zend Framework, Yii2, JavaScript, jQuery, Smarty
Data & messaging	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Memcached, Elasticsearch, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, NoSQL
Architecture	Microservice architecture, high-load system design, DDD, event-driven architecture
Engineering practice	Code review, refactoring, PHPUnit, Docker, Git, Linux server administration, Agile
Spoken languages	Russian — native; English — B2 (upper-intermediate)